

Company Structure & Governance Manual

Asteron Systems, Inc.

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This document is a fictional sample created for product demonstrations and UI testing. It does not describe any real organization, and it is not legal, HR, or compliance advice.

Field	Value
Owner	Operations Excellence (Fictional)
Approved by	Executive Leadership Team (Fictional)
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Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Notes
0.9	2026-02-21	Demo Author	Initial demo release with governance, policies, and operating model.
0.8	2026-02-14	Demo Author	Added management structure, committees, and RACI tables.
0.7	2026-02-07	Demo Author	Drafted core policy summaries and escalation paths.

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1. Company Overview

Asteron Systems, Inc. ("Asteron") is a fictional B2B software company that builds workflow automation tools for regulated operations (logistics, payments reconciliation, and compliance reporting). This manual describes how the company is structured, how decisions are made, and the baseline policies used to operate safely and consistently.

Attribute	Detail
Legal name	Asteron Systems, Inc. (fictional)
Headquarters	2147 Meridian Way, Redwood Harbor, CA 94000 (fictional address)
Business units	Product, Platform Engineering, Customer Success, Sales, Finance, People & Culture, Legal & Compliance
Primary systems	Ticketing (OrbitDesk), Source control (ForgeHub), HRIS (SproutHR), Finance (LedgerLake) - all fictional
Operating principles	Clarity, customer trust, measurable outcomes, and learning loops

1.1 Governance model

Asteron uses a lightweight governance model: a small Executive Leadership Team (ELT) owns strategy and risk, while cross-functional councils own product, technology, and operational standards. Decisions are documented, auditable, and reversible when practical. Where reversibility is low (security, legal, finance), approvals are explicit and time-stamped.

1.2 Decision-making principles

- One directly responsible individual (DRI) per decision.
- Clear inputs: context, options, trade-offs, and a default recommendation.
- Written records for any decision that changes customer impact, budget, headcount, security posture, or regulatory exposure.
- Post-decision review: measure outcomes and revise the playbook when reality disagrees with the plan.

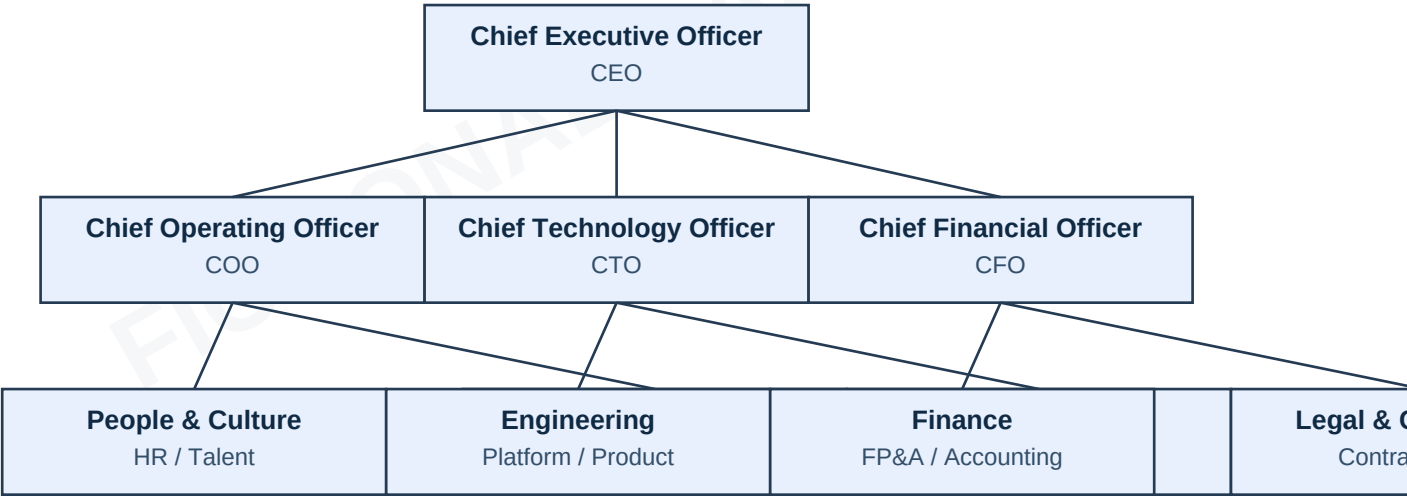
2. Management Structure

2.1 Executive Leadership Team (ELT)

Role	Name (fictional)	Primary responsibilities
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	Maya Kline	Company strategy, culture, executive decisions, external representation
Chief Operating Officer (COO)	Rafael Ortega	Delivery cadence, cross-team operations, customer success, enablement
Chief Technology Officer (CTO)	Priya Nandakumar	Architecture, engineering standards, reliability, security partnership
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	Ethan Park	Budgeting, financial controls, procurement approvals, forecasting
General Counsel (GC)	Leila Morgan	Contracting, compliance, privacy/legal risk, corporate governance support

2.2 High-level org chart (text + diagram)

The diagram below illustrates the primary reporting lines for major functions. Dotted-line relationships (e.g., Security partnering with Engineering and Legal) are described in committee charters.



2.3 Management layers and role definitions

Asteron uses three leadership layers for day-to-day operations:

- Directors: Own multi-quarter roadmaps and budgets across multiple teams.
- Managers: Own execution for a team or program; accountable for delivery, quality, and people development.
- Team Leads: Senior individual contributors who coordinate technical direction and unblock delivery.

FICTIONAL SAMPLE

3. Committees, Councils, and Cadence

3.1 Standing groups

Group	Chair	Cadence	Scope
Executive Leadership Team (ELT)	CEO	Weekly	Strategy, priorities, budgets, top risks, cross-org trade-offs
Product Council	COO	Biweekly	Roadmap alignment, customer commitments, launch readiness
Architecture Review Board (ARB)	CTO	Biweekly	Major technical changes, platform standards, long-term scalability
Security Council	CISO (interim)	Monthly	Threat posture, controls, incident learnings, audit readiness
Change Advisory Board (CAB)	SPR Lead	Weekly	High-risk changes, maintenance windows, rollback plans
Risk & Compliance Committee	CFO	Monthly	Policy exceptions, vendor risk, regulatory mapping, controls coverage

3.2 Escalation path

When work becomes blocked, risky, or time-sensitive, Asteron escalates in this order:

- 1) Team Lead or Program DRI
- 2) Functional Manager / Director
- 3) Appropriate council (Product Council, ARB, CAB, Security Council)
- 4) ELT (for budget, headcount, legal exposure, or customer-impacting reversals)

The goal is fast clarity, not blame. Any escalation should include: problem statement, impact, time window, and recommendation.

4. Decision Rights and Approval Matrix

4.1 Common decisions

Decision	DRI	Approver(s)	Notes
Customer-facing product launch	Product Manager	COO + CTO	Requires launch checklist, rollback plan, support
Security control changes	Security Lead	CTO + GC	High-risk changes reviewed by Security Council
Vendor contract > \$50k/year	Procurement Lead	CFO + GC	Requires vendor risk review and budget confirma
Hiring (new headcount)	Hiring Manager	COO + CFO	Requires headcount plan alignment and compen
Budget reforecast	Finance Partner	CFO	Monthly, with ELT visibility

4.2 RACI sample (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed)

Activity	Product	Engineering	Security	Finance	Legal	Customer Success
Feature release	A	R	C	I	I	C
Incident response (sev 1)	C	R	A	I	C	R
New vendor onboarding	C	C	C	A	R	I
Contract exception	I	I	C	C	A	I
Quarterly planning	R	R	C	C	I	C

5. Core Policies (Summaries)

These are intentionally short, demo-friendly summaries. Real organizations typically maintain detailed policy documents with legal review, training modules, and audit evidence.

5.1 Code of Conduct

All employees and contractors act with integrity, avoid conflicts of interest, respect colleagues, and escalate concerns early. Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and misuse of company resources are prohibited.

5.2 Information Security

Security is built into design and operations. Use company-managed devices, least-privilege access, MFA, and approved tooling. High-risk data is encrypted in transit and at rest. Report suspected incidents within 30 minutes.

5.3 Data Privacy

Collect only necessary data, retain it only as long as needed, and honor contractual and legal obligations. Privacy reviews are required for new data types, new sharing partners, or new analytics pipelines.

5.4 Acceptable Use of Systems

Company systems are for business purposes. Prohibited: credential sharing, unapproved external storage, production data in personal accounts, and running unvetted code on production systems.

5.5 Procurement and Vendor Risk

All vendors undergo a risk review proportional to data access and spend. Contracts require security and privacy terms when vendors handle customer data.

5.6 Travel and Expenses

Spend company money as if it were your own: necessary, reasonable, and documented. Receipts are required for reimbursement. Managers approve exceptions.

5.7 Remote Work and Availability

Remote work is supported with clear expectations: core collaboration hours, documented decisions, and reliable incident coverage rotations.

6. Operating Model and Ways of Working

6.1 Planning cadence

Asteron uses a quarterly planning cycle with monthly business reviews:

- Weekly: Team execution reviews (deliverables, risks, dependencies).
- Biweekly: Product Council (roadmap and launch readiness).
- Monthly: Business Review (metrics, customer health, budget, hiring).
- Quarterly: Strategy and planning (OKRs, staffing, major bets).

6.2 Documentation norms

Operational work is written down. Minimum artifacts:

- One-pager for any new initiative: problem, customer impact, scope, success metrics, owner, timeline.
- Launch checklist and rollback plan for customer-impacting releases.
- Post-incident review within five business days for sev 1 and sev 2 events.

6.3 Change management (CAB)

Changes that are high-risk or high-impact (production schema changes, auth changes, vendor cutovers) require a CAB review.

The CAB validates:

- Backout plan and blast-radius estimate
- Observability (logs, metrics, alerts)
- Customer communications plan (if applicable)
- Scheduled maintenance window for disruptive work

6.4 Incident management (summary)

Severity levels:

- Sev 1: Customer outage or critical security incident (ELT notified immediately).
- Sev 2: Major degradation with workaround (council notified; daily updates).
- Sev 3: Limited impact; normal ticket workflow.

Roles:

- Incident Commander (IC): owns timeline and decisions
- Communications Lead: customer and internal updates
- Subject Matter Experts (SMEs): investigation and fixes

Appendix A. New Hire Onboarding Checklist (Sample)

Day	Owner	Checklist items (sample)
Day 1	People & Culture	Access provisioning, security training, handbook acknowledgement, equipment verification
Week 1	Manager	Role expectations, first deliverable, stakeholder map, onboarding buddy assigned
Week 2	Team Lead	Repo walkthrough, local dev setup, first code review, runbook reading
Week 4	Manager	30-day review, development plan, confirm on-call readiness (if applicable)

Appendix B. Key Contacts (Fictional)

Function	Email	Typical use
Governance / policies	governance@asteron.example	Policy questions, document change requests
Security	security@asteron.example	Incidents, access reviews, vendor questionnaires
Legal	legal@asteron.example	Contracts, privacy questions, compliance mapping
Finance	finance@asteron.example	Budgets, procurement approvals, reimbursements
People & Culture	people@asteron.example	Benefits, onboarding, performance cycles

Appendix C. Glossary (Sample)

- DRI: Directly Responsible Individual - the single owner for a decision or outcome.
- OKR: Objectives and Key Results - a method for setting and tracking goals.
- CAB: Change Advisory Board - group that reviews high-risk operational changes.
- ARB: Architecture Review Board - group that reviews major technical decisions.
- MFA: Multi-factor authentication - additional verification step beyond passwords.